

BUBBLE TEA NEWS

Issue 1 · 17 July 2026 · Complimentary — please take one bubbletea.nz · est. 2026



BREAKING · WILLOWMERE ESTATES

Gnome Outbreak Hits 41 Homes

Risk assessed Moderate after cross-street spread was confirmed via a shared fence line. A formal bylaw was narrowly voted down.

community-outbreak-bulletin

POLITICS · DISPATCH

On the Age of the Leak

Richard Nixon

"A government that fears its own leaks more than it fears the conditions that produce them has already lost the argument."

BUSINESS · MARKETS

View From the Desk

Sherman McCoy

"I moved size on that paper before Chip Ashworth had finished his second coffee." Eleven points by the close.



TECHNOLOGY · PRODUCT

One More Thing

The new cable is eleven percent shorter. "This isn't a cable. This is a statement about proximity. About intention."

Steve Jobs

WORLD DESK

Trade Summit Tent Collapses Mid-Speech

Baxter Kline

"I am no longer entirely sure where my other shoe went." The accord will still be signed tomorrow, from a better-anchored tent.

BUBBLE TEA TRIVIA

Did You Know?

Pearl milk tea was invented in Taichung, Taiwan, in the early 1980s — and two rival tea stalls still argue over who invented it first.



In Every Issue

A new logic puzzle

Fresh local trivia

A rotating cast of columnists

Local ad space, weekly

"I took the Continental Grain twenty-years at 9:20 this morning — four hundred million face."

— Sherman McCoy, closing eleven points up

JOKE OF THE WEEK

Why did the tapioca pearl refuse to argue? It didn't want to get into a sticky situation.



LIFESTYLE · ESTATES

The Delacroix-Byrne Estate

"Underneath the marble and the mosaic, they are, every last one of them, still standing in someone's kitchen." Champagne wishes, caviar dreams.

Robin Leach



GOSSIP · KISS & TELL

Book Club Spoiler Scandal

"My sources — three ladies deep into the biscuit tin — confirm it goes all the way to the top shelf, darling."

The Stickybeak

DINING · REVIEW

Sprout & Stone: 1.5 Lasagnas

Garfield

"I arrived expecting food. I was served a single radish on a river stone." Do not come here on a Monday.

RURAL NOTES

Higgins Edges Doyle by Four Sheep

Clem Whitlock, Ridgeline Weekly

Season-opening shear-off tally: 181 to 177. Dagging season starts the second week of next month.

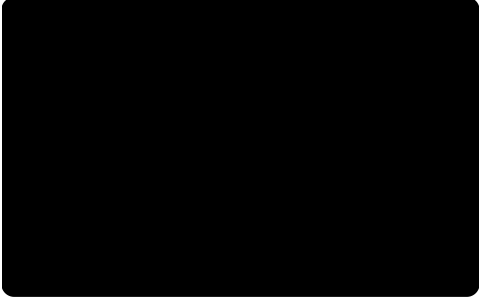


PUZZLE OF THE WEEK

The Four Puzzlers

- 1. Ben sits immediately left of Ava; Ben drinks water.
- 2. The coffee drinker sits immediately left of Cleo.
- 3. Cleo drinks juice. Dmitri isn't in seat 1. Ava doesn't drink coffee.

Answer in next week's edition — Ken Endo



WEATHER DESK

A Six Mile-an-Hour "Whisper"

Dana Foley

"That is not a wind. That is a whisper — the sky leaning in close to tell Millhaven Valley a secret it isn't ready to hear."

AUTOMOTIVE

Route 9 Motors — Labor Day Clearance

Lewis Hamilton

"You do not walk onto this lot. You attack it." Podium financing available.

CLASSIFIEDS · TE MANA WHAKAATU FRAMEWORK

This Week, Rated

FLATMATE WANTED — Rated M. "Contains a cockatiel with strong and frequently expressed views."

IN MEMORIAM

The Ten-Punch Loyalty Card

Skeletor

Fools mourn many things. I mourn efficiently, and only what deserves it. Willowmere's tea counter has, this week, retired its paper loyalty card — ten holes, one free cup, an empire of ink and cardboard that ruled this district longer than certain civilizations I could name. I confess nothing about the missing punch machine. I confess nothing about the app that replaced it, either. Mourn if you must. I, of course, already have. Twice.

ASK THE CAPTAIN

Uneasy in Willowmere

Horatio McCallister

"My partner keeps 'liking' a stranger's photos online and I don't know if I should say something." Arrr, Uneasy. A ship that drifts toward another harbour, even just to look at the lights, is a ship worth asking about its heading. Ye don't need to fire a cannon over it — just ask plain where she means to sail. I once sailed three years without asking my first mate a single honest question. Learned nothing. Don't be like me. Fair winds.

THE BOBA SIDE

IMAGE-GENERATION PROMPT — NOT RENDERED ARTWORK

Prompt: Chibi gag-manga panel; bold rounded linework; pastel garden-green and warm terracotta palette; 4-koma comedic density; cozy-menacing atmosphere; clean flat-color digital finish. An original chibi garden-gnome character peers from behind a hedge, huge sparkling eyes, one tiny hand raised in a "shh" gesture, a bubble tea cup clutched to its chest like contraband.

"THE GNOME KNOWS."

The Boba Side — prompt script, awaiting illustration